

BLAMO CLOSING

Automotive sales training

Follow-Up That Creates Customers for Life

The Sale Doesn't End When the
Customer Leaves—It Begins There.

Training Objective

By the end of this chapter, you'll know how to:

- ✓ Build a follow-up system that generates consistent appointments.
- ✓ Stay top of mind without becoming annoying.
- ✓ Turn unsold prospects into future buyers.
- ✓ Create lifelong customers through post-sale communication.
- ✓ Generate referrals and repeat business naturally.

Why Follow-Up Matters

Let's look at the numbers.

A customer walks into your dealership today.

They don't buy.

Did you lose the sale?

Not necessarily.

Many customers don't purchase because:

- ✓ They're still researching.
- ✓ They're comparing dealerships.
- ✓ They're waiting on a trade.
- ✓ They're discussing it with a spouse.
- ✓ They're waiting for payday or a tax refund.
- ✓ Life simply got in the way.

The salesperson who follows up consistently is often the one who earns the sale.

Remember This:

Customers rarely buy from the first salesperson who contacts them. They buy from the salesperson who remains helpful and memorable.

The Golden Rule of Follow-Up

Every follow-up should answer one question:

“Why is this person contacting me today?”

If every message simply says:

“Are you ready to buy?”

Customers will stop responding.

Instead, give them a reason to engage.

The 10-Day Prospect Follow-Up Plan

Day 1 - Thank You

Call within two hours if possible.

Example:

"Hi Sarah, this is Jake at ABC Motors. I wanted to thank you again for stopping by today. It was a pleasure meeting you. If any questions come up tonight, don't hesitate to call or text me."

Day 2 - Helpful Information

Send something useful.

Example:

"I was thinking about our conversation yesterday. Here's a quick video showing the safety features we discussed."

Day 3 - Personal Check-In

Example:

"Hi Sarah! I wanted to see if any new questions came up after looking everything over."

Day 4 - Social Proof

Example:

"We actually delivered another one just like yours today. The customer absolutely loved it."

Day 5 - Value Reminder

Example:

"One thing I forgot to mention is how well these hold their value."

Day 6 - Educational Follow-Up

Share:

- ✓ Maintenance costs
- ✓ Warranty information
- ✓ Fuel economy
- ✓ Awards
- ✓ Owner reviews

Day 7 - Phone Call

Example:

“Sarah, I wanted to check in personally because I know purchasing a vehicle is a big decision. What’s the biggest question still on your mind?”

Day 8 - Story

Tell a customer success story.

People remember stories more than statistics.

Day 9 - Appointment Ask

Example:

“I’d love another opportunity to show you the vehicle. Would tomorrow afternoon or Saturday morning work better?”

Day 10 - The Soft Close

Example:

“Whether you purchase from us or somewhere else, I appreciate the opportunity to help. If you need anything at all, I’m here.”

Ironically, this message often receives replies because it removes pressure.

The 90-Day Long-Term Follow-Up

Many buyers don't purchase immediately.

Stay connected.

Month 1

- ✓ One phone call
- ✓ One text
- ✓ One helpful email

Month 2

- ✓ Check inventory
- ✓ Ask about timing
- ✓ Offer assistance

Month 3

Reach out personally.

Example

"Hi Sarah! Just checking in. Have your plans changed at all since we last spoke?"

Follow-Up Mistakes

Avoid:

- X “Just checking in.”
- X “Are you ready yet?”
- X “Still interested?”
- X “Did you buy somewhere else?”

Those messages provide no value.

Instead:

- ✓ Offer information.
- ✓ Ask thoughtful questions.
- ✓ Share something helpful.
- ✓ Invite conversation.

The SOLD Customer Process

Many salespeople disappear after delivery.

Top performers become lifelong advisors.

Delivery Day

Before the customer leaves:

- ✓ Pair their phone.
- ✓ Program favorite radio stations if requested.
- ✓ Demonstrate key features.
- ✓ Schedule the first service visit if appropriate.
- ✓ Thank them sincerely.

Then say:

"You're part of our dealership family now. If you have any questions—even if they seem small—please call me first."

24-Hour Follow-Up

Call.

"Hi Sarah! I just wanted to make sure everything is going well with your new vehicle. Have you had a chance to drive it much?"

3-Day Follow-Up

Text:

"Just checking in to see if you've discovered a favorite feature yet."

One-Week Follow-Up

Ask:

"Do you have any questions about any of the technology or features?"

One-Month Follow-Up

"How has the vehicle been treating you?"

This is also a great time to ask for an online review.

Asking for Reviews

Example

“Sarah, I’m so glad you’re enjoying your vehicle. If you felt I earned a five-star review, it would mean a lot to me personally. Reviews help future customers know what kind of experience to expect.”

Make it about helping future customers—not just helping you.

Referral Process

The best time to ask for referrals?

When the customer is happiest.

Example

“Can I ask you a quick favor? If you have any friends, family, or coworkers who are thinking about buying a vehicle, I’d love the opportunity to help them the same way I helped you.”

Birthday Follow-Up

Text:

“Happy Birthday, Sarah! I hope you have an amazing day. Thank you again for trusting me with your vehicle purchase.”

No selling.

Just appreciation.

Vehicle Anniversary

One year later:

“Happy one-year anniversary with your vehicle! It’s hard to believe it’s already been a year. I hope you’re still loving it.”

Service Follow-Up

Customers visiting the service department are future buyers.

Call:

“Hi Sarah! I noticed your vehicle was in for service. While it’s being taken care of, I wanted to see if you’ve ever considered upgrading. Sometimes we can get customers into a newer vehicle for a payment that’s surprisingly close to what they’re already spending.”

Manager's Tip

People don't like being sold.

They do appreciate being remembered.

The difference is intention.

Follow up because you genuinely care—not because you're desperate for a commission.

Customers can feel the difference.

Practice Drill

Choose five customers from your CRM who haven't heard from you in at least 30 days.

Instead of asking if they're ready to buy, send each one a message that:

- ✓ References a previous conversation.
- ✓ Provides something useful.
- ✓ Ends with an easy question that invites a response.

Review the replies with your manager. Notice which messages spark conversations and which fall flat.

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Most sales happen after multiple follow-up attempts.
- ✓ Every contact should provide value or strengthen the relationship.
- ✓ Consistency beats intensity.
- ✓ Sold customers are your best source of reviews, referrals, and repeat business.
- ✓ Customers remember salespeople who stay involved after the sale.
- ✓ Great follow-up creates lifelong relationships, not one-time transactions.

Sales Coach's Challenge

Never think of follow-up as “checking in.”

Think of it as continuing the conversation.

If every customer interaction answers one question—“How can I help this person today?”—you’ll stop sounding like a salesperson and start becoming a trusted advisor. And trusted advisors don’t just sell cars; they build businesses powered by repeat customers, referrals, and lasting relationships.

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